HOW CANDY CANES ARE MADE

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the passage carefully. Circle one answer for each multiple choice question, and write full sentences for the others. Look back at the text before you decide.

How Candy Canes Are Made

163 words

A candy cane begins as a pot of boiling sugar, corn syrup and water. The mixture is heated to about 300 degrees Fahrenheit, which is hotter than an oven set for cookies. Then it is poured onto a cooled steel table. Workers wearing thick gloves fold the hot candy again and again. Folding pulls tiny bubbles of air into it, and that is what turns the clear candy bright white. Peppermint oil is kneaded in for flavor. A smaller piece is colored red. The red piece is laid in strips along the white block, and the whole block is rolled into a long rope. The rope is stretched thinner and thinner, and the stripes twist around it like a barber's pole. A machine cuts the rope into sticks. While the sticks are still warm, the end of each one is bent into a hook. The hook is what makes a candy cane a cane: it lets the candy hang on a tree branch.

1. What turns the clear candy white?

the red strips | air bubbles from folding | the peppermint oil

2. When is the hook made?

while the sticks are still warm | after the candy is cold | before the stripes are added

3. In this text, "kneaded" means WORD

poured | pressed and worked in by hand | cut into pieces

4. List the ingredients in the first pot, in order.

5. Why do you think the workers wear thick gloves? THINK

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ANSWER KEY

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4. List the ingredients in the first pot, in order.

Sugar, corn syrup and water.

5. Why do you think the workers wear thick gloves? THINK

The candy is extremely hot (about 300 degrees) and would burn their hands.